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Entrepreneurial Metacognition

Discover an entrepreneur in yourself

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"Entrepreneur Metacognitive awareness is an individual's aggregate consciousness of their own thought process to perform any specific entrepreneurial task or how they take decisions in the business for the long term benefits. And, there is a lot of research and techniques, which can help develop entrepreneurial skills in youngsters."

Think about thinking as a practice of purposeful introspection. Developed metacognitive abilities bring a person's thought processes to the foreground, where they can be improved by analysis. Metacognition requires you to make space for self-reflection, such as journaling your

thoughts, review your own thinking, and partnered conversation about the process with like-minded peers. Beware any cognitive biases you might hold. Systematic errors in your thinking can occur while processing information. Being aware of thought processing errors is an important step in managing cognitive biases.

Given the Darwinian nature of the free market, where most businesses perish or languish in mediocrity, it is



Individual awareness and aggregate conscious has been exhibited by way of modern science

a daunting task to try and set off by yourself. It is so much easier to find an existing business where you join the ranks and minimise risk. Then again, the appeal of entrepreneurship is the potential success. Starting an entrepreneurial endeavour has always been difficult, even in pro-business and banking-focussed countries such as Germany and the U.K. Half of the startups in those countries collapse in five years or under. India, amongst the biggest supporters of new business alongside Europe and the U.S, sees the majority of its start-ups fail within the first year itself, while America fares little better. There is an eighty percent failure rate for independent businesses within ten years of their opening.

PATHS TO SUCCESS

James Hayton and Gabriella Cacciotti from Harvard Business Review have conducted interviews with 65 entrepreneurs, which revealed that the common metacognitive phenomenon was the fear that start-up founders share, however, somewhat surprisingly, it also revealed that these same fears can be helpful. While fear can often inhibit actions, there are some fears that can motivate us to work harder towards our goals. Worries about financial security, opportunity costs, and obtaining funding can all be positively associated with the persistence that defines an entrepreneur's success.

Hamish Hughes, an investor and Cambridge graduate told his alma mater, "Fail Fast, but learn from your failures. There's no point in throwing things at the wall to see if they stick, and not paying attention to why they don't. And there's a fine line between believing in your product and being delusional. At the first sign of failure, you don't want to pack up, go home and say 'clearly no one wants this'. But if you're hearing over and over again that people hate the idea – or an aspect of it – it's time to learn and take action."

It might seem unrelated, but Alanna Nash writes in her biography of Elvis Presley about how his manager, realising there was a backlash against